# From Guidelines to Practice: Do NLP Papers Follow Reporting Requirements?

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## Abstract

A completed reporting checklist does not show that a natural language processing (NLP) paper contains the information the checklist asks for. We propose an evidence-based audit of long main-conference papers at ACL and EACL (2023–2026). For four checklist requirements, two raters locate the required details before the authors' declarations are revealed and compared with the evidence. A secondary goal tests whether automated systems can reproduce these judgments with valid evidence.

## 1 Scientific Goal of the Project

**Problem.** The Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) requires papers at its Annual Meeting and at the Conference of the European Chapter of the ACL (EACL) to include a Limitations section and the Responsible NLP Research Checklist of ACL Rolling Review (ARR). Authors answer each question with Yes, No or N/A, point to the evidence for a Yes, and may justify a No (ACL Rolling Review, n.d.). What papers then actually report is known only from self-reports (Magnusson et al., 2023) and from audits of section presence (Thaepprasit et al., 2026). We address the gap between a *requirement*, the author's *declaration* and the documented *evidence*.

**Scope.** To establish clear boundaries, our audit strictly targets *reporting compliance*, not underlying research validity or execution practice. Specifically, a label of `COMPLETE` indicates that every required detail defined in our frozen rubric (Table 2)—spanning limitations (L-a, L-b), artifact attribution (D-a, D-b), experimental setup and hyperparameter disclosures (E-a, E-c), and human participant instruction texts (H-a)—is fully documented within the paper or its declared supplements. It does not imply that the research complies with all broader venue guidelines, nor does it guarantee factual correctness or experimental reproducibility; similarly, a justified "No"declaration by authors is categorized as compliant rather than a violation. The scope is methodologically bounded by the criteria evaluated across our double-rated sample and remains descriptive, meaning empirical conclusions are strictly limited to the sampled population of long papers from ACL and EACL (2023–2026) and cannot be generalized beyond these venues or formats.

**Research questions.** The audit is the primary goal. **RQ1:** How often are the details required by each criterion reported completely, partially or not at all? **RQ2:** How often is a Yes declaration not fully supported by the evidence? **RQ3:** Which required details are most often missing? The secondary goal asks **RQ4:** Can automated systems reproduce the adjudicated judgments with valid evidence?

**Terminology.** We assess four reporting criteria: limitations (L), attribution of artifact sources (D), experimental setup (E), and instructions to human participants (H). We compare three automated assessment methods: heading and keyword rules (S1), generic questions posed to a language model (S2), and classification using retrieved evidence and an explicit reporting rubric (S3).

**Hypotheses.** **H1:** Grounded in prior findings on structural mandate compliance versus human evaluation reporting (Thaepprasit et al., 2026; Schmidtova et al., 2025; Belz et al., 2023), complete reporting is most frequent for limitations (L) and least frequent for instructions to human participants (H). **H2:** Motivated by prior evidence of checklist over-reporting (Magnusson et al., 2023; Goldberg et al., 2024), at least 10% of Yes declarations with resolved evidence are only partially supported or unsupported. **H3:** Building on established reproducibility audits (Dodge et al., 2019; Schmidtova et al., 2025; Mei et al., 2026), the

most often missing details concern hyperparameters (E) and instruction text (H), not artifact attribution (D). **H4:** Motivated by prior work on limitations analysis and automated checklist assessment (Thaepprasit et al., 2026; Galarnyk et al., 2025), evidence-grounded classification (S3) outperforms heading and keyword rules (S1) and generic questions (S2) in macro-F1, and S1 overestimates complete reporting of limitations (L).

## 2 Significance of the Project

### 2.1 State of the art

**Standards.** Frameworks such as Data Statements (Bender and Friedman, 2018), Datasheets (Gebru et al., 2021), Model Cards (Mitchell et al., 2019), Ethics Sheets (Mohammad, 2022), and responsible-data checklists (Rogers et al., 2021), alongside the experimental items of Dodge et al. (2019), define what researchers should document and form the basis of the ARR checklist (ACL Rolling Review, n.d.). However, none of these guidelines measures actual adherence.

**Declarations versus content.** None of 50 EMNLP 2018 papers reported all the items proposed by Dodge et al. (2019). In 10,405 checklist responses to EMNLP 2020–2021, NAACL 2021 and ACL 2021, only 46% *claimed* to release code; such self-reported reporting rose after the checklist was introduced (Magnusson et al., 2023). The 74.4% code rate of accepted papers at the Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2019 (Pineau et al., 2021) concerns another venue, stage and outcome. Content audits find persistent omissions. Of 47 natural language generation (NLG) papers from checklist venues, 14 omit annotation guidelines and 31 omit compensation details (Schmidtova et al., 2025). Only 1 of 20 papers allows its human evaluation to be repeated (Belz et al., 2023). Long-form-generation papers meet a median of 7 of 20 criteria (Mei et al., 2026), and 75% of 55 large language model (LLM) evaluation papers omit randomness controls (Pattnayak and Bhatia, 2026). Yet Limitations sections appear in 97.8% of EMNLP 2022 and 100% of EMNLP 2025 papers (Thaepprasit et al., 2026), which measures presence, not content. Documentation improved even before checklists (Coakley et al., 2026), and compute (Strubell et al., 2019) or duplicated data (Bandy and Vincent, 2021) can stay hidden behind headline results.

**Automated assessment.** An LLM checklist assistant used at NeurIPS 2024 seemed useful to about 70% of 63 surveyed authors. Yet rewriting its justifications without changing the paper raised its scores in 14 of 15 categories (Goldberg et al., 2024). ConfReady (Galarnyk et al., 2025) gathered 1,975 ACL 2023 papers (34 without a checklist, 114 with a blank one). On 93 long papers, its retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) setup agrees with the authors' answers in 81.7–81.9% of cases: agreement with declarations, not evidence of their support. Table 5 in Appendix B details all 18 studies.

### 2.2 Justification and pioneering nature

No reviewed study links, for the same papers, (i) the requirement of the venue edition, (ii) the author's declaration, and (iii) an independent, located judgment of the evidence. Self-report studies lack (iii), content audits lack (i) and (ii), and checklist assistants are scored against (ii). This project aims to map checklist questions to verifiable details per edition, mask declarations during assessment, make RQ2 feasible through published checklists, and score automated checkers against evidence-based labels.

### 2.3 Expected impact

Publishing organizations learn which questions are answered 'Yes' without support; authors and reviewers learn which details are commonly missing. The method moves reporting research from self-reporting to a more quantitative approach.

## 3 Concept and Work Plan

### 3.1 Concept

Figure 1 summarises the pipeline. Raters assess papers with the checklist pages removed, then resolve disagreements to produce the final human reference labels. Only afterward are the authors' checklist declarations compared with the assessed evidence. The three automated systems also assess the papers without access to checklist declarations or human reference labels. Their configurations are fixed at F4, and their predictions are subsequently compared with the human reference labels to measure performance.

### 3.2 Specific research goals and deliverables

The project has four specific goals: **O1**, an edition-level requirements rubric; **O2**, adjudicated and located judgments for 60 papers; **O3**, answers to

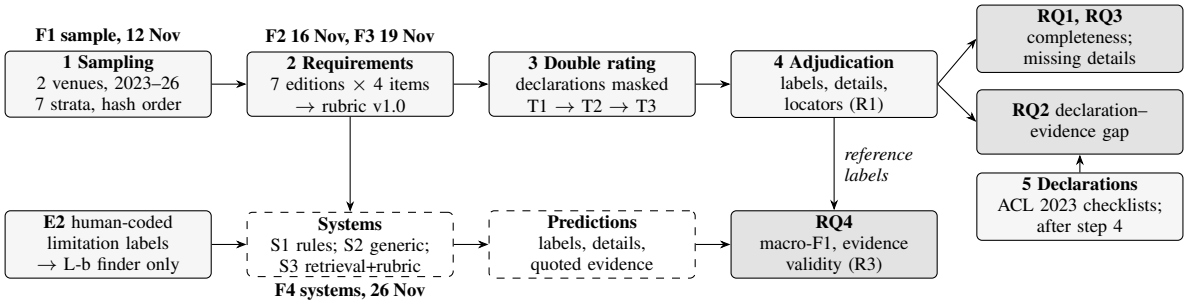



Figure 1: Pipeline. The human audit (top) answers RQ1–RQ3; the systems (bottom, dashed) are frozen at F4 and scored against the adjudicated labels (RQ4). F1–F4: freeze points; T1–T3: evidence tiers (§4.3).

RQ1–RQ3; and **O4**, a comparison of automated systems (RQ4). They lead to three deliverables:

- **R1 Audit corpus v1.0** (13 Dec; Marcus Leong): the register, the rubric, 480 ratings and up to 240 adjudicated records. *Accepted if* all records pass schema validation, each `COMPLETE` or `PARTIAL` label has a locator and each `ABSENT` label a search log, and agreement is reported per criterion.
- **R2 Audit report** (15 Jan; Krzysztof Tkaczyk, Maciej Momot): answers to RQ1–RQ3 and verdicts on H1–H3. *Accepted if* each estimate shows its numerator, denominator and 95% interval, unresolved and inapplicable cases are listed, and claims stay within the sampled population.
- **R3 System comparison** (20 Dec; Marcus Leong, Jakub Półtorak): S1–S3 on the 50 held-out papers. *Accepted if* one script regenerates all metrics from the released predictions and frozen configuration, negative results included.

### 3.3 Work plan and timeline

Table 4 gives the weekly plan. The owners are Jakub Półtorak (corpus, sampling), Krzysztof Tkaczyk (register), Maciej Momot (annotation quality) and Marcus Leong (automation, release). In six rotating pairs, each member reads 30 papers, which at 45–60 minutes per reading totals 90–120 person-hours.

### 3.4 Results of preliminary research

Completed so far are the literature review (§2, Appendix B) and script-based checks of the external data, stored in `checks/` (Appendix C). Our parse of ConfReady (E1) reproduces its 1,975-record response table exactly. Of the 910 ACL 2023 Main-long papers, 895 include a checklist. Yes answers are common for A1 (limitations, 831), C2 (setup, 740) and B1 (artifact citation, 650) but rare for D1 (instructions, 242), which limits RQ2 (§4.2). The human-coded *What Limits Us?* release (E2, `READY`) has 150 papers with 606 labels; 18 of its papers (ACL 2023–2025) come from the volumes we sample. E1 (counts verified; identifiers and licence open), P1–P3 and the optional E3–E6 remain `TO COLLECT`. Retrieval of E4 and E5 failed (Table 7), and no pilot label exists yet.

| Risk (likelihood) | Mitigation or fallback |
|---|---|
| 1 Few Yes declarations for RQ2 (H) | E1 supplement; rates only with $\geq$10 per criterion |
| 2 Few human-participant papers (H) | Three H-development papers; own denominator |
| 3 Unverifiable requirement (M) | `UNRESOLVED`; descriptive only |
| 4 Pilot >60 min per paper (M) | Supplement cut to 6 papers before F3 |
| 5 Pilot $\alpha < 0.667$ (M) | Rules revised before F3; criterion flagged |
| 6 Model drift; unclear licences (M) | Pinned local model; internal data use only |
| 7 Pretraining exposure (C) | Rule baseline; evidence-validity check |

Table 1: Risk analysis; likelihood H = high, M = medium, C = certain.

### 3.5 Risk analysis

Table 1 lists the main risks. The most serious is the scarcity of public declarations for RQ2.

## 4 Approach and Research Methodology

### 4.1 Methodological basis

The study is a cross-sectional document audit based on structured content analysis, as in earlier content audits (Dodge et al., 2019; Schmidtova et al., 2025; Mei et al., 2026). It adds four safeguards: a probability sample in fixed hash order,

requirement-derived criteria, independent double rating with masked declarations, and freeze points before any evaluation label exists. Estimation is descriptive; venues and years are not ranked.

### 4.2 Population and sampling

The population consists of long papers in the main proceedings of ACL (`acl-long`, 2023–2026) and EACL (`eacl-main` in 2023, `eacl-long` in 2024 and 2026; EACL had no 2025 edition). These form seven venue-edition strata. Findings, short, workshop, demonstration and tutorial papers are excluded; the 2023 EACL volume mixes lengths, so a paper there counts as long if its body before the references exceeds five pages. Within each stratum, papers are screened in SHA-256(`42|ID`) order. The first eligible paper becomes a development paper, and the next ones enter the main sample, 20 per venue: 5 per ACL edition and 7, 7 and 6 for EACL 2023, 2024 and 2026 (40 papers).

Completed checklists are printed in ACL 2023 papers (Galarnyk et al., 2025). ARR announced checklist appendices from EMNLP 2025 onwards (ACL Rolling Review, 2025), yet our sampled paper from every other edition in the population, including ACL and EACL 2026, contains none; availability is confirmed per paper at screening. RQ2 therefore adds a *supplement*. Its frame is the 242 ACL 2023 Main-long papers that answer Yes to D1 in E1, each verified on the printed checklist and ranked by the same hash. Ranks 1–3 become H development papers, and ranks 4–13 form the supplement. Because it is selected on a declaration, the supplement serves only RQ2 and RQ4. From E1's Yes rates, we expect about 11–14 Yes declarations per criterion. All lists are frozen at F1 (12 Nov), and no other papers serve development. Sampled papers are excluded from E2 development use; an unavailable paper is replaced by the next rank and logged.

### 4.3 Requirement mapping and annotation

Krzysztof Tkaczyk records each edition's requirements and Maciej Momot verifies them (P2). Each criterion is tied to one checklist question and its details (Table 2), so a Yes is compared only with what its own question asks. Details without a policy counterpart stay out of RQ1 and RQ2.

Two raters independently enumerate the in-scope objects (datasets and models, main experiments, human studies), mark each detail as present or missing with a locator, and assign `COMPLETE`, `PARTIAL`, `ABSENT`, `UNCLEAR` or `NOT_APPLICABLE` (Appendix D). Raters and systems share one evidence scope: the main text (T1); appendices and Anthology attachments (T2); and external material only where the paper points to it for that detail, archived on retrieval (T3). Labels are recorded after T1 and again after T1–T3. Declarations (Yes, No, N/A, blank, unavailable, other) and justifications are recorded only after the content labels are final. From these separate fields, a Yes is *supported*, *partially supported* or *unsupported* (`COMPLETE`, `PARTIAL` or `ABSENT`). A No is a *justified omission* if its justification meets an exception that the policy allows. A member who rated neither copy adjudicates, and both ratings are kept.

### 4.4 Automated assessment

S1 applies heading and keyword rules to sections parsed by GROBID (Lopez, 2009). S2 asks a fixed open-weight model, Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, one generic question per criterion over the full text. S3 gives the same model BM25-retrieved paragraphs (Robertson and Zaragoza, 2009; Lewis et al., 2020), the matched edition requirement and the details in Table 2, and returns a label, the satisfied details and verbatim quotes (for `ABSENT`, the sections searched). Development uses only the 10 development papers and E2, which serves only the L-b statement finder. Two ablations change one factor each: the current ARR text replaces the matched requirement, or the evidence is limited to T1. Declarations are never inputs; the model, prompts, retriever and chunking are frozen at F4 (26 Nov).

### 4.5 Analysis of results

**RQ1.** Here, $c$ denotes the reporting criterion, and $n_C$, $n_P$, and $n_A$ denote the numbers of COMPLETE, PARTIAL, and ABSENT cases, respectively. For criterion $c$, $p_c = n_C/(n_C + n_P + n_A)$ is computed over applicable, resolved main-sample cases. It is reported with the `PARTIAL` and `ABSENT` shares, 95% Wilson intervals (Wilson, 1927), and the counts of unclear, inapplicable and unresolved cases. Pooled rates are reported unweighted and stratum-weighted. Where declarations exist, incomplete cases with a justified No are counted. **RQ2.** For $g_c$, these counts include only applicable, resolved cases with a Yes declaration. The gap $g_c = (n_P + n_A)/(n_C + n_P + n_A)$

| Criterion | Checklist question (ACL 2023) | Details (COMPLETE: all, for every in-scope object; PARTIAL: some; ABSENT: none) | N/A if |
|---|---|---|---|
| L Limitations | A1 "Did you describe the limitations of your work?" and the edition's section rule | L-a: dedicated section where the edition requires one; L-b: at least one limitation specific to this paper's method, data, evaluation or scope (boilerplate or future work alone does not count). *Descriptive:* L-x, a stated consequence for the claims. | never |
| D Artifact sources | B1 "Did you cite the creators of artifacts you used?" | D-a: every existing dataset behind the main results is attributed (citation or named release); D-b: every pretrained model behind the main results is attributed. | no existing data or models |
| E Experimental setup | C2 "Did you discuss the experimental setup, including hyperparameter search and best-found [...] values?" | For each main experiment: E-a, data split and training or inference procedure; E-b, the search procedure, or an explicit statement that none was run; E-c, final hyperparameter or decoding values. | no experiments |
| H Instructions | D1 "Did you report the full text of instructions given to participants [...]?" | H-a: the full instruction text of every study with human annotators or participants (paper, appendix or archived linked instrument); a summary counts only toward PARTIAL. *Descriptive:* H-x screenshots, H-y risk disclaimers. | no human participants |

Table 2: From checklist questions to assessed details. Question wording per edition is stored in P2, which tags each detail as edition-required, question-derived or descriptive.

is computed over Yes declarations with resolved, applicable content, separately for the main and supplement samples. It is reported only with at least 10 such declarations (else as counts); pooled rates use a paper-cluster bootstrap (2,000 resamples). **RQ3.** The share of applicable cases missing each detail is reported with Wilson intervals and ranked. **Agreement.** Krippendorff's $\alpha$ (nominal) is computed per criterion on the pre-adjudication labels, together with raw agreement; $\alpha \geq 0.667$ is the minimum for tentative conclusions (Artstein and Poesio, 2008). **RQ4.** Systems are scored on the 50 held-out papers; reference UNCLEAR cases are excluded and counted. We report per-class precision, recall and F1 and confusion matrices. Macro-F1 averages over the classes with at least one reference instance (the others are listed), and a system UNCLEAR counts as an error. *Evidence validity* is the share of COMPLETE and PARTIAL outputs whose quotes occur verbatim and support the claimed details, as judged by a rater (a second rater checks 20%). Intervals use a paper-level bootstrap, paired for S3 versus S1 and S2. **Decision rules.** H1 holds if the interval for $p_L - p_H$ lies above 0, and H2 if the lower bound of the pooled gap exceeds 0.10. H3 holds if the two most often missing details belong to E or H. H4 holds if both paired macro-F1 intervals exceed 0 and S1's COMPLETE rate for L exceeds the human rate. Given the small samples, unsupported hypotheses are reported as inconclusive.

### 4.6 Data statement

Following Bender and Friedman (2018). **Sources:** Public ACL Anthology papers, policy pages, and external datasets (E1–E6) used under their respective terms. **Data and processing:** The audit processes English scientific texts evaluated by the four project team members. **Personal data:** Papers contain names, affiliations, and emails. To protect privacy, records store only Anthology IDs, location markers, and brief quotes; raters are pseudonymised, and findings are reported in aggregate. **Release:** Annotations, rubrics, and registers will be released under a CC BY 4.0 license, while source texts are not redistributed.

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## 5 Contribution and LLM Use

| Member | Phase 1 tasks (this report) | Hours |
|---|---|---|
| Jakub Półtorak | Literature review, data scope analysis, source dataset research | [4] |
| Krzysztof Tkaczyk | Literature review, data scope analysis, source dataset research P2 plan | [4] |
| Maciej Momot | Automated assessment design, annotation protocol and agreement plan, risk and analysis plan | [4] |
| Marcus Leong | Automated assessment design, annotation protocol and agreement plan, risk and analysis plan | [4] |
| All | Research questions and hypotheses, editing | [5] |
| Total | | [21] |

Table 3: Contribution of each team member to the Phase 1 report.

**Declaration of LLM use.** We used Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic), through the Claude Code assistant, to restructure the draft into the required proposal format, to edit the language, to check internal consistency (counts, labels and cross-references), and to write the verification scripts in `checks/` that recount E1 and E2 and test sample Anthology PDFs for printed checklists. An AI feedback assistant ChatGPT critiqued the draft against the course rubric. Finally, we used NLP platform Grader LLM to assess the report against the Assessment Criteria. No LLM produced research data nor labels. Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct appears in this report only as an object of study (S2 and S3 in Section 4).

## 6 Project Literature

Each entry below is cited in Sections 1–4 or, for one data source, in Appendix C, and serves one of five roles: *reporting frameworks and policies* (Bender and Friedman, 2018; Gebru et al., 2021; Mitchell et al., 2019; Mohammad, 2022; Rogers et al., 2021; ACL Rolling Review, n.d.; ACL Rolling Review, 2025); *empirical audits of reporting*, the evidence base for H1–H3 (Dodge et al., 2019; Magnusson et al., 2023; Pineau et al., 2021; Schmidtova et al., 2025; Belz et al., 2023; Mei et al., 2026; Pattnayak and Bhatia, 2026; Thaepprasit et al., 2026; Coakley et al., 2026; Strubell et al., 2019; Bandy and Vincent, 2021); *automated checklist assessment*, the motivation for RQ4 (Goldberg et al., 2024; Galarnyk et al., 2025); *data sources* (Galarnyk et al., 2025; Thaepprasit et al., 2026; Mei et al., 2026; Kunilovskaya et al., 2026); and *methods and tools* (Artstein and Poesio, 2008; Wilson, 1927; Lewis et al., 2020; Robertson and Zaragoza, 2009; Lopez, 2009). Only one of the 24 scholarly entries is a preprint (Goldberg et al., 2024); no peer-reviewed version was found on 4 November 2026.

## A Project Schedule

Table 4 contains the detailed schedule of the planned works.

| Week | Dates | Tasks (owner) | Milestone |
|---|---|---|---|
| W1 | 2–8 Nov | Literature table final (all); E1/E2 checks (Marcus Leong); volume lists (Jakub Półtorak); policy retrieval for 7 editions (Krzysztof Tkaczyk) | E1/E2 checked (4 Nov) |
| W2 | 9–15 Nov | Screening and hash draws (Jakub Półtorak; check Krzysztof Tkaczyk); register (Krzysztof Tkaczyk; check Maciej Momot); masked rating copies (Jakub Półtorak); pilot ratings, 10 papers (all) | **F1** sample (Thu 12) |
| W3 | 16–22 Nov | Pilot adjudication, agreement, timing (Maciej Momot); rubric v1.0 (Krzysztof Tkaczyk, Maciej Momot); S1–S3 development (Marcus Leong, Jakub Półtorak); main ratings from Fri 20 (all) | **F2** register (Mon 16), **F3** rubric (Thu 19) |
| W4 | 23–29 Nov | Main and supplement ratings (all); held-out system runs with sealed outputs (Marcus Leong) | **F4** systems (Thu 26) |
| W5 | 30 Nov–6 Dec | Ratings completed (all); agreement monitoring (Maciej Momot) | 400 ratings (Sun 6) |
| W6 | 7–13 Dec | Adjudication by non-raters (Maciej Momot, rotating); corpus validation and packaging (Marcus Leong) | **R1** corpus (Sun 13) |
| W7 | 14–20 Dec | RQ1–RQ3 and H1–H3 (Krzysztof Tkaczyk, Maciej Momot); RQ4 metrics, evidence validity and ablations (Marcus Leong, Jakub Półtorak) | **R3** results (Sun 20) |
| W8–9 | 21 Dec–3 Jan | Winter break; buffer only | — |
| W10 | 4–10 Jan | Error analysis (Marcus Leong); drafting: audit (Krzysztof Tkaczyk, Maciej Momot), automation (Marcus Leong, Jakub Półtorak) | Draft (Sun 10) |
| W11 | 11–17 Jan | Internal review; data statement and release check (all) | **R2** report (Fri 15) |

Table 4: Week-by-week schedule (2026–2027), with task owners in parentheses.

## B Comparative Evidence

**How to read the evidence.** Each quantitative result names its source corpus and evaluated subset. The audits, surveys, inventories and analyses of author responses listed here report no train/dev/test performance, so a split is "not applicable" to their *audit statistics*; their populations and filters are stated instead. ConfReady's automated-answer benchmark is a separate evaluation task, and its subsets are named. Denominators, units and policy applicability differ, so percentages are not directly comparable. Framework rows describe proposed requirements, not measured adoption.

Table 5: What each of the 18 reviewed studies does, on which material and evaluated subset, and what it reports.

| **Work** | **Method / contribution** | **Dataset / evaluation subset or split** | **Published outcome (scope)** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bender & Friedman (2018) | Data Statements reporting framework. | Linguistic datasets with speaker and annotator metadata; illustrative statements, no audit sample or split. | Proposes population and collection disclosures; no measured compliance rate. |
| Gebru et al. (2021) | Datasheets reporting framework. | Question set covering the dataset lifecycle (motivation to maintenance); conceptual, no compliance sample or split. | Proposes lifecycle documentation questions; no adoption-effect estimate. |
| Mitchell et al. (2019) | Model Cards reporting framework. | Two illustrative model cards (smiling detection on CelebA; toxicity detection); no adoption study or split. | Proposes intended-use and disaggregated-evaluation documentation; no compliance rate. |
| Mohammad (2022) | Ethics Sheets framework. | Ethical assumptions of AI tasks, illustrated with automatic emotion recognition; no audit split. | Proposes task-level questions; no measured uptake. |
| Rogers et al. (2021) | Responsible-data checklist proposal. | Acquisition, licensing, reuse and sharing of NLP data; conceptual, no audit split. | Checklist later incorporated into ARR guidance; no measured adherence rate. |

*Table 5 continued*

| Work | Method / contribution | Dataset / evaluation subset or split | Published outcome (scope) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dodge et al. (2019), §5 | Manual experimental-reporting audit. | EMNLP 2018: 50 randomly chosen empirical papers (audit sample; train/dev/test not applicable). | 0/50 report every proposed item; 74% report at least some best-hyperparameter information. |
| Magnusson et al. (2023), abstract, §2, Table 2 | Analysis of self-reported NLP checklist answers. | 10,405 anonymous responses of non-withdrawn submissions (13,655 submitted minus 3,250 withdrawn or desk-rejected) to EMNLP 2020, EMNLP 2021, NAACL 2021 and ACL 2021; response corpus, not a model split. | 46% *claim* to release code; several declared reporting items increase after the checklist; associations are observational. |
| Galarnyk et al. (2025), §3–4, Tables 1–2 | ConfReady: checklist audit and RAG checklist answering. | ACL 2023 (checklists published with accepted papers): 1,975 papers for completeness counts. Evaluation-only stratified sample of 50 per track/length category, 186 after conversion failures; 43 Findings-long and 50 Main-long used in Table 2; no tuning split reported. | Full corpus: 34/1,975 lack a checklist; 114/1,975 are blank. Contextual RAG with Llama-3.1-405B: 81.72% (Findings-long) and 81.93% (Main-long) accuracy against authors' responses, not verified compliance. |
| Schmidtova et al. (2025), §3–4 | Manual audit of NLG human-evaluation reporting against checklist topics. | 61 selected NLP papers with 64 human evaluations (2019–2024); *47 papers from venues using the checklist* for checklist-related results; no model split. | Of 47 papers, 14 (30%) omit guidelines, 30 (64%) omit interface details, 31 (66%) omit payment information. |
| Belz et al. (2023), §2.2 | Human-evaluation repeatability audit. | 20 random ACL/TACL/EMNLP papers (26 experiments) sampled from 631 eligible papers; no model split. | 1/20 (5%) provide enough public material to repeat the evaluation; not a rerun success rate. |
| Mei et al. (2026), §5.1 | Manual audit of long-form-generation evaluation reports. | 284 eligible *CL 2023–2025 papers coded manually (audit subset; no model split). | Median 7/20 reporting criteria; remuneration reported in 29%, ethics-board determination in 11%. |
| Thaepprasit et al. (2026), Fig. 2, Table 3 | Structural section audit and thematic coding. | ACL/EMNLP 2020–2025: 16,067 Limitations sections; *structural rates* for EMNLP 2022 (1,376 papers) and EMNLP 2025 (3,214 papers). | Dedicated Limitations sections in 97.8% (2022) and 100% (2025) after verification; presence rates only. |
| Pattnayak & Bhatia (2026), abstract | Audit of LLM evaluation pipelines; proposes ReproEvalCard. | 55 selected 2022–2025 papers from NLP and ML venues and arXiv; audit sample, no model split. | Randomness controls missing in 75% and execution traces in 61% of audited papers. |
| Coakley et al. (2026) | Longitudinal automated documentation audit. | AAAI, ICLR, ICML, IJCAI and NeurIPS, 2014–2024: 56,800 screened and 52,328 empirical papers; prevalence corpus, no model split. | Documentation improvements precede checklist adoption; no isolated causal effect of mandates. |
| Pineau et al. (2021), Table 1 | NeurIPS reproducibility-programme report. | NeurIPS 2019 accepted papers at camera-ready. Table 1 gives 6,743 submissions and a 21.1% acceptance rate but no paper count beside the rate. | 74.4% with code at camera-ready (40% at submission); availability, not reproduction success. |
| Strubell et al. (2019), Table 4 | Development-compute accounting. | Development logs of one model (LISA): 172 days of jobs; not a paper audit or model split. | 4,789 jobs and 239,942 reported GPU-hours across development. |
| Bandy & Vincent (2021), Table 2 | Retrospective BookCorpus data audit. | All 11,038 original-format BookCorpus files; corpus inventory, no split. | 7,185 unique books; 2,930 distinct books appear more than once. |
| Goldberg et al. (2024), §4–5 | Checklist-assistant trial and adversarial rewriting. | NeurIPS 2024: 63 paired-survey participants; adversarial experiment on 234 submissions (184 distinct papers); no model split. | About 70% of surveyed participants find it useful; rewritten justifications raise mean scores in 14/15 categories without changing papers. |

Table 6 repeats every quantitative result of Table 5 as one row per published number, with its metric, dataset and evaluated subset or split. Framework papers and Coakley et al. (2026) report no single headline number and are omitted.

Table 6: Published numbers of the reviewed studies, each tied to its dataset and evaluated subset or split.

| Work | Metric | Value | Dataset | Subset / split |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Dodge et al. (2019) | Papers reporting every proposed item | 0/50 | EMNLP 2018 papers | 50 random empirical papers; audit sample, no split |
| | Papers with some best-hyperparameter information | 74% | same | same |
| Magnusson et al. (2023) | Responses claiming code release | 46% | Checklist responses, EMNLP 2020–21, NAACL 2021, ACL 2021 | 10,405 non-withdrawn submissions; no split |
| Galarnyk et al. (2025) | Papers without a checklist; with a blank checklist | 34/1,975; 114/1,975 | ConfReady, ACL 2023 papers | Full corpus; no split |
| | Accuracy of contextual RAG (Llama-3.1-405B) against authors' answers | 81.72%; 81.93% | same | Evaluation-only test sample: 43 Findings-long; 50 Main-long; no tuning split |
| Schmidtova et al. (2025) | Papers omitting guidelines; interface details; payment information | 14 (30%); 30 (64%); 31 (66%) of 47 | NLG human-evaluation papers, 2019–2024 | 47 papers from checklist venues (of 61); audit sample |
| Belz et al. (2023) | Papers whose human evaluation can be repeated | 1/20 (5%) | ACL, TACL and EMNLP papers | 20 random of 631 eligible; audit sample |
| Mei et al. (2026) | Median reporting criteria met | 7/20 | *CL 2023–2025 long-form-generation papers | 284 manually coded papers; audit sample |
| | Papers reporting remuneration; ethics-board determination | 29%; 11% | same | same |
| Thaepprasit et al. (2026) | Papers with a dedicated Limitations section | 97.8%; 100% | EMNLP 2022; EMNLP 2025 | 1,376; 3,214 papers; structural audit |
| Pattnayak & Bhatia (2026) | Papers missing randomness controls; execution traces | 75%; 61% | NLP/ML venue and arXiv papers, 2022–2025 | 55 selected papers; audit sample |
| Pineau et al. (2021) | Papers with code at camera-ready; at submission | 74.4%; 40% | NeurIPS 2019 | Accepted papers (6,743 submissions); no split |
| Strubell et al. (2019) | Development jobs; GPU-hours | 4,789; 239,942 | LISA development logs | 172 days of jobs; no split |
| Bandy & Vincent (2021) | Unique books; books appearing more than once | 7,185; 2,930 | BookCorpus | All 11,038 files; no split |
| Goldberg et al. (2024) | Participants finding the assistant useful | about 70% | NeurIPS 2024 checklist assistant | 63 paired-survey participants |
| | Categories with higher scores after rewriting | 14/15 | same | 234 submissions (184 papers); adversarial experiment |

## C Dataset Register and Acquisition Evidence

**Snapshot: 4 November 2026.** Counts distinguish publication claims, repository documentation and our own file checks. The check scripts, their outputs and SHA-256 checksums of the inspected files are kept in `checks/` (`MANIFEST.md`). A downloaded file is not automatically a validated compliance dataset. All dates are planned 2026 deadlines, and all new annotation is still planned. Owners are named in §3.3; no private submissions or confidential review material are used.

| Resource | Role | Status; size or target | Labels | Class balance |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| P1 paper corpus | sample and documents | TO COLLECT; 60 papers (10 development, 40 main, 10 supplement) | none (sampling metadata only) | not applicable; fixed allocation by stratum and role |
| P2 requirement register | applicable requirements | TO COLLECT; 7 editions × 4 criteria = 28 mappings | strength `REQUIRED` / `RECOMMENDED` / `UNSPECIFIED`; `NO_MATCH`, `UNRESOLVED` | unknown; reported at F2 |
| P3 human judgments | reference labels | TO COLLECT; 480 ratings → at most 240 adjudicated records | `COMPLETE`, `PARTIAL`, `ABSENT`, `UNCLEAR`, `NOT_APPLICABLE`; detail flags | unknown until collection |
| E1 ConfReady (ACL 2023) | declarations; supplement frame | TO COLLECT (counts verified; identifiers and licence open); 1,975 records | declaration states Yes, No, N/A, blank, no response, other | Main-long Yes of 910: A1 831, B1 650, C2 740, D1 242 (Table 8) |
| E2 What Limits Us?, human | L-b statement finder | READY; 150 papers, 606 labels | 50 multi-label limitation topic strings (49 classes per data card) | most frequent: Non-Limitation: Future Work 110, Scope Limitation 83 of 150 papers (Table 9) |
| E3 What Limits Us?, LLM | optional context | TO COLLECT; 16,047 records | LLM-assigned topics, 50 codes | source-reported: Future Work 12,041, Scope Limitation 10,091, Sparse Data Sensitivity 3 of 16,047 |
| E4 Illusions, manual subset | optional H check | TO COLLECT; 284 papers (file absent) | item-level decisions on 20 reporting criteria | unknown (file absent) |
| E5/E6 Who annotates? | optional H check | TO COLLECT; 41 / 1,603 papers (repository 404) | task-level annotation-reporting attributes (human / LLM-extracted) | unknown (data not obtained) |

**Table 7:** Resources, status, labels and class balance (details in the paragraphs below). READY: inspected and usable for the stated role; TO COLLECT: acquisition or validation unfinished; RESTRICTED: confirmed access or reuse restriction (none at present). Unverified licensing alone does not make a resource restricted.

### C.1 Primary project data

**P1. Paper corpus and sample — TO COLLECT. Size:** 60 distinct papers: 10 development papers (the first eligible paper of each of the 7 strata, plus ranks 1–3 of the supplement frame), 40 main papers (20 per venue) and 10 supplement papers. The strata are ACL 2023–2026 (`acl-long`) and EACL 2023 (`eacl-main`), 2024 and 2026 (`eacl-long`); EACL had no 2025 edition. The eligible stratum sizes $N_s$ are estimated from screening, not assumed. **Labels:** Anthology ID, stratum, sample role, eligibility decision and reason, document URL, version and checksum, and hash rank; no outcome labels. **Class balance:** no outcome classes at this stage; the allocation is fixed (1 development paper per stratum; 5 main papers per ACL edition and 7, 7 and 6 for EACL 2023, 2024 and 2026; 3 development and 10 supplement papers from the supplement frame). **Licence:** ACL Anthology material from 2016 onwards is generally CC BY 4.0; item-level and third-party rights are checked against the Anthology copyright page. **Acquisition:** official volume pages, final PDFs and Anthology-hosted attachments, with URL, retrieval date, version and checksum. Jakub Półtorak screens and draws by 12 November (F1), and Krzysztof Tkaczyk checks the eligibility decisions. Jakub Półtorak also prepares rating copies with the checklist pages removed. An unavailable document keeps a missingness record and is replaced by the next hash rank, never on the basis of its apparent reporting.

**P2. Requirement register — TO COLLECT.** **Size:** 7 venue-edition records, each with requirement text for four criteria (28 mappings); the number of source documents is recorded on retrieval. **Labels:** exact requirement text, edition, stage (submission or camera-ready), effective date, source version, strength (`REQUIRED`, `RECOMMENDED` or `UNSPECIFIED`) and applicability conditions. A rubric detail without a policy counterpart receives `NO_MATCH`; unverifiable history receives `UNRESOLVED`. **Class balance:** not an outcome corpus; counts by strength and mapping state are reported at F2. **Licence:** source-specific. We keep links, provenance and only the necessary excerpts; our mappings are proposed for release under CC BY 4.0. **Acquisition:** Krzysztof Tkaczyk extracts calls for papers, checklist versions and camera-ready instructions from official or archived pages by 12 November; Maciej Momot verifies all 28 mappings by 16 November (F2). Policies introduced later are not applied retrospectively.

**P3. New human evidence annotations — TO COLLECT.** **Size:** 240 paper–criterion cases (40 development, 160 main, 40 supplement). Two independent ratings per case give 480 ratings (80, 320 and 80, respectively). Adjudication yields at most 240 final records, which are not 480 independent observations. **Labels:** content label (Table 10), present/missing flags per detail, evidence locators per tier, applicability, declaration, justification and policy mapping. **Class balance:** unknown until collection. Each label's count and share will be published per criterion, stratum and sample role, with denominators; the main sample is not balanced. **Licence:** proposed CC BY 4.0 for the annotations and rubric, conditional on team and supervisor agreement; source texts keep their rights. **Acquisition:** all members rate in six rotating pairs (10 papers per pair). Maciej Momot coordinates agreement checks and adjudication by a member who rated neither copy. Milestones: pilot ratings 17 November; rubric freeze (F3) 19 November; main and supplement ratings 6 December; adjudication 10 December; corpus v1.0 13 December.

### C.2 External resources: verified scope and conditional use

**E1. ConfReady ACL author-response component — TO COLLECT (counts verified; identifiers and licence open).** **Size:** `dataset/all_datasets.xlsx` at commit `5cd6bee270c7` contains 1,975 titled ACL 2023 records—910 Main-long, 164 Main-short, 712 Findings-long and 189 Findings-short—with 19 author-response fields each. Two records lack an ACL link and await identifier repair. Non-ACL sheets and `_llm` fields are not used. **Labels:** the original author text, normalised to the states Yes, No, N/A, blank, "No response" and other. These are declaration states, not compliance labels. Question wording and skip logic follow the official ACL 2023 instrument, not the repository's informal summaries. **Class balance:** Table 8 gives the full counts. In the Main-long subset, Yes answers number 831 (A1), 650 (B1), 740 (C2) and 242 (D1) of 910. **Licence:** the repository licence is AGPL-3.0. Whether it covers the spreadsheet and the embedded paper text is unclear, so the table is used internally and not redistributed; the source papers keep their own licences. **Acquisition:** the workbook was downloaded from the pinned commit and parsed without running repository code. Jakub Półtorak and Marcus Leong validate identifiers and response states by 11 November, and Krzysztof Tkaczyk maps the 19 fields to the official questions by 12 November. Supplement candidates are checked against their printed checklists in hash order before F1; a mismatch moves the draw to the next rank.
**Version discrepancy.** The workbook's `have_checklist` field contains 1,930 Yes and 45 No values, whereas the paper reports 34 papers without a checklist and 114 with a blank one. The repository README mentions 22 questions, but the workbook has 19 author-response fields. These are differences between the release and its documentation that need reconciling; they do not replace the published audit. A Yes with an empty justification ("[Yes] Left blank.") remains a Yes declaration, and the missing pointer is recorded separately.

**E2. What Limits Us?, human-coded release — READY (auxiliary component only).** **Size:** `human_code.csv` at commit `c77e5f8faf64` contains 150 rows with 150 unique paper IDs and 606 code assignments (535 from the codebook, 71 created by annotators); the data card reports 1,036 segmented sentences. **Labels:** paper-level multi-label lists of limitation and non-limitation topics, alongside the verbatim Limitations section. The codes are not aligned to sentence spans and are not compliance labels. **Class balance:** Table 9 lists the paper-level frequencies of all 50 raw strings. Totals exceed 150

because the labels are multi-label, and 99 records have no annotator-created code. The data card reports 49 classes. The 50th string is probably an alias: "Lack of Evaluation Metrics" (1 paper) beside "Lack of Evaluation Metrics or Benchmarks" (4 papers). We merge the two only for the auxiliary task. **Licence:** CC BY 4.0 in the repository and data card, with attribution of the verbatim text to the original authors. **Acquisition:** the public CSV and data card were retrieved and checked; the labels come from the source team (four annotators with consensus reconciliation). **Role:** development and testing of the component that proposes candidate paper-specific limitation statements (detail L-b) for S3; it never measures completeness. The source excluded papers without an identifiable Limitations section, and its sampling is non-uniform (68 of 150 papers are from 2024), so it supports no prevalence estimate. Eighteen papers come from the volumes we sample (ACL 2023–2025; none from EACL); any of them that is drawn into our samples is removed from E2 development use. Maciej Momot and Marcus Leong freeze the auxiliary split by 13 November.

**E3. What Limits Us?, LLM-coded release — TO COLLECT (optional).** **Size:** the data card describes 16,047 released paper records in four files (1,595; 4,024; 4,159; 6,269), 84,930 code assignments and a final 50-code vocabulary. The publication reports 16,067 extracted sections; the two counts describe different objects and are not substituted for each other. The large files have not been downloaded or recounted. **Labels:** LLM-assigned limitation and non-limitation topics with evidence fields; the codebook version depends on the year group. **Class balance:** the data card reports Future Work in 12,041 and Scope Limitation in 10,091 of 16,047 papers, against 3 for Sparse Data Sensitivity; these are source-reported multi-label frequencies. **Licence:** CC BY 4.0 in the repository and data card. **Acquisition:** Marcus Leong may import the four pinned files (16,047 records) by 13 November and validate IDs, counts and evidence offsets; no reannotation is planned. The labels are machine-generated, so this resource serves only as exploratory context, never as a reference. It can be omitted without affecting the audit.

**E4. Illusions of the Gold Standard, manual subset — TO COLLECT (conditional).** **Size:** 284 manually reviewed papers and 20 reporting criteria according to Mei et al. (2026); the released row and cell counts are not verified. The separately reported 1.8k+ LLM-assisted papers are not part of this import. **Labels:** item-level reporting decisions about human-evaluation protocols. The published codebook merges "No or N/A" for some fields, and such a category cannot be mapped automatically to our separate labels. **Class balance:** per-item distributions cannot be recounted without the annotations; no balanced-class assumption is made. **Licence:** the inspected repository carries an MIT licence for its released contents, which does not establish the terms of annotation files absent from that snapshot. **Acquisition:** the repository tree at `99523eb6d645` contains analysis code and a README referring to `data/raw_human_annotation.csv`, but that path is absent. Maciej Momot will request the 284-paper export, codebook and data terms by 13 November, through a public release or an authorised request; no request has been sent yet. The annotations belong to the source team; Maciej Momot and Marcus Leong only review compatibility. If the data are unavailable at F3, this check is dropped and the published rubric serves as methodological context.

**E5. Annotated_gold — TO COLLECT (conditional).** **Size:** 41 papers and 72 annotation tasks according to Kunilovskaya et al. (2026). **Labels:** human-adjudicated, task-level attributes of annotation reporting; these multiple categorical and numeric fields are not interchangeable with a single paper-level label. **Class balance:** unverified until the files and a field dictionary are obtained; per-field counts and missingness will be reported instead of one overall rate. **Licence:** unverified; the paper's licence does not establish the terms of an unavailable dataset. **Acquisition:** the publication points to `NL2G/who-are-the-annotators`, and the repository request returned HTTP 404 on 4 November. This shows a failed retrieval, not a legal restriction or the absence of the data. Maciej Momot will seek the 41-paper export and its terms by 13 November; if unresolved by 19 November, the resource is not used.

**E6. Annotated_llm — TO COLLECT (optional, conditional).** **Size:** source-reported 1,603 papers and 2,667 extracted annotation tasks from 2018–2025. **Labels:** automatically extracted task-level attributes, not human reference judgments. **Class balance:** not verified; field-specific value and missingness distributions will be computed after acquisition. **Licence:** unverified, with the same retrieval problem as E5. **Acquisition:** Marcus Leong may seek the export, schema and terms by 13 November. The resource would serve only for exploratory case discovery after overlap checks and is not a dependency of the audit.

### C.3 Source locations and check tables

Public source locations, checked on 4 November 2026:

- Anthology acquisition and rights: `https://aclanthology.org/` and `https://aclanthology.org/faq/copyright/`.
- ConfReady workbook and README: `https://github.com/gtfintechlab/ConfReady/tree/5cd6bee270c736b7a9d496c0a42c3ea5109426cc/dataset`.
- Human- and LLM-coded limitations releases, licences and data cards: `https://github.com/Sundione/nlp-self-reported-limitations/tree/c77e5f8faf647df8ec6b3ee6471c46d0bd871b63`.
- Illusions repository snapshot: `https://github.com/larchlab/Illusions-of-the-Gold-Standard/tree/99523eb6d645c2510fefd159b1dd622a3a27f234`.
- Annotation-reporting source (retrieval unsuccessful): `https://github.com/NL2G/who-are-the-annotators`; publication: `https://aclanthology.org/2026.emnlp-main.396/`.

These checks establish release structure and response frequencies only; they produce no compliance result. The publications in Appendix B keep their reported numbers. The annotation-reporting publication (Kunilovskaya et al., 2026) is a data source for E5 and E6, not one of the 18 reviewed studies.

| Field | Yes | No | N/A | Blank | No response | Other |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A1 | 1811 | 0 | 1 | 159 | 0 | 4 |
| A2 | 1066 | 384 | 363 | 159 | 0 | 3 |
| A3 | 1807 | 5 | 0 | 159 | 0 | 4 |
| A4 | 121 | 1682 | 9 | 162 | 0 | 1 |
| B1 | 1384 | 21 | 132 | 159 | 275 | 4 |
| B2 | 770 | 400 | 358 | 159 | 284 | 4 |
| B3 | 871 | 262 | 397 | 159 | 284 | 2 |
| B4 | 411 | 481 | 638 | 159 | 284 | 2 |
| B5 | 976 | 148 | 405 | 159 | 285 | 2 |
| B6 | 1375 | 56 | 97 | 159 | 287 | 1 |
| C1 | 1512 | 140 | 66 | 159 | 90 | 8 |
| C2 | 1618 | 43 | 63 | 159 | 91 | 1 |
| C3 | 1525 | 113 | 84 | 159 | 94 | 0 |
| C4 | 1407 | 108 | 215 | 159 | 86 | 0 |
| D1 | 434 | 106 | 359 | 159 | 917 | 0 |
| D2 | 436 | 93 | 373 | 159 | 914 | 0 |
| D3 | 342 | 111 | 450 | 159 | 913 | 0 |
| D4 | 197 | 145 | 561 | 159 | 913 | 0 |
| D5 | 306 | 128 | 469 | 158 | 868 | 46 |

**Table 8:** Provisional lexical response states in the 1,975-record ACL 2023 workbook (E1), reproduced by `checks/e1_table.py`. These are author-answer states, not compliance labels. "No response" may reflect skip logic; "Blank" combines empty cells and the literal "Left blank."; answer prefixes are classified before justification completeness is checked. Every row totals 1,975, and ambiguous text remains Other.

| Codebook code (`existing_code`) | Papers | Annotator-created code (`new_code`) | Papers |
|---|---|---|---|
| Non-Limitation: Future Work | 110 | Lack of Generalizability | 20 |
| Scope Limitation | 83 | Inferior Results | 12 |
| Methodological Constraints | 64 | Non-Limitation: Recommended Practice | 5 |
| Non-Limitation: Contextual Justification | 49 | Reliance on Human Effort | 4 |
| Non-Limitation: Strong Reported Performance | 36 | Prompt Sensitivity | 3 |
| Non-Limitation: Method Details | 36 | Reliance on Human Annotation | 3 |
| Non-Limitation: Method Strength | 22 | Lack of Data Quality | 2 |
| High Resource Requirements | 22 | Environmental Impact | 2 |
| High Time Consumption | 14 | Incomplete Data | 2 |
| Dataset Bias/Imbalance | 14 | Closed Source Data | 2 |
| Non-Limitation: Conducted Mitigation | 14 | Non-Limitation: Extrapolation | 2 |
| Subjectivity in Evaluation/Annotation | 10 | Dependency in Specific Data | 1 |
| Data Scarcity | 10 | Low Community Engagement | 1 |
| Dependency on Upstream Quality | 9 | Risk of Sensitivity Data | 1 |
| Dataset Noise/Errors | 8 | Non-Limitation: Disclaimer | 1 |
| Reliance on External Tools | 7 | Fast-pace Research | 1 |
| Model Hallucination/Incoherence | 6 | Implementation Complexity | 1 |
| High Financial Cost | 5 | Model Reliability | 1 |
| Non-Limitation: Anticipated Impact | 4 | Model Scarcity | 1 |
| Lack of Evaluation Metrics or Benchmarks | 4 | Dataset Mismatch | 1 |
| Performance Trade-off | 3 | Hidden Labeling Cost | 1 |
| Potential for Misuse | 2 | Knowledge Cutoff | 1 |
| Lack of Interpretability | 1 | Lack of Access to Closed-Source Models | 1 |
| Data Leakage/Contamination | 1 | Lack of Reproducibility | 1 |
| Lack of Evaluation Metrics (probable alias) | 1 | Hyperparameter Sensitivity | 1 |

**Table 9:** Paper-level frequencies of all 50 raw label strings in the E2 human-coded release (150 papers; 535 codebook and 71 annotator-created labels), reproduced by `checks/e2_balance.py`. A paper counts once per label; columns do not sum to 150.

# D Annotation and Evaluation Protocol

## D.1 Content labels and decision rules

The research checks in Table 2 are aligned with the exact historical instruction of each edition in P2 and frozen after the pilot (F3). A check that is stricter than a venue's instruction is reported as a research check, not as a venue obligation, and a detail without a matched instruction is analysed descriptively.

| Content label | Decision rule |
|---|---|
| `COMPLETE` | The criterion applies, and every required detail is supported for every in-scope object within the evidence scope. |
| `PARTIAL` | At least one required detail is supported and at least one is missing; the supporting evidence is located. |
| `ABSENT` | The criterion applies, no qualifying evidence is found, and the full search protocol (T1–T3) has been completed and logged. |
| `UNCLEAR` | Applicability or adequacy cannot be decided, or missing or unreadable material prevents a defensible decision; the reason is recorded. |
| `NOT_APPLICABLE` | The relevant activity or object is absent under the frozen applicability rule (Table 2), with an explicit rationale. |

**Table 10:** Content labels. Separate fields store the declaration (Yes, No, N/A, blank, unavailable, other) and the justification of a No, including whether it addresses the policy's exception rule. The RQ2 outcomes (supported, partially supported, unsupported, justified omission, not applicable) are derived from these fields.

For D, E and H, raters first enumerate the relevant objects. The paper–criterion pair is the unit of analysis: individual parameters or datasets are never counted as separate cases, and object-level notes are kept so that the aggregation can be inspected. Edge rules settled in the pilot and frozen at F3 include: whether authors who annotate their own data count as human participants for H; how inference-only LLM experiments satisfy E-b and E-c (decoding settings, or an explicit statement that no search was run); and the fact that an LLM used as a judge is not a human participant.

## D.2 Reading sequence, masking and adjudication

Raters read the main text (T1), then appendices and Anthology-hosted attachments (T2), then external material that the paper explicitly points to for the detail in question (T3), archived on the retrieval date. A T1-only label is recorded before T2–T3 are consulted, and later changes are added rather than overwriting it. Checklist pages are removed from the rating copies and are not evidence; if masking fails, the exception is recorded. After the content label is final, the declaration and justification are revealed and recorded. Six rater pairs rotate across the 60 papers (10 papers per pair), and the adjudicator is always one of the two members who rated neither copy. Maciej Momot monitors agreement during the main ratings.

The minimum record fields are `paper_id`, venue, year, sample role, document URL, hash and version, criterion and rubric version, policy source, version and strength, applicability, detail-level flags, content label, evidence tier, page and section, paraphrase, search-log completion, missing-material reason, raw declaration, justification, pseudonymous rater ID and adjudicated label. Imported external records add the source dataset, commit, original label and mapping version. Raw responses are preserved through normalisation.

## D.3 Splits and leakage control

Development uses only the 10 development papers (and E2 for the L-b component). The 40 main and 10 supplement papers are held out until F4 and evaluated together for RQ4. External records are matched by Anthology ID, and unmatched titles are checked by hand. All material from one paper—text, appendices, supplements and declarations—stays in one split. Declarations are never system inputs. Where developers already know an external resource's labels, that resource is used for development or description, not as a blind test. Pretraining exposure of public papers cannot be excluded and is reported as a limitation of the model evaluation.